

I'm afraid that you'll probably have to say yes to this one, though, because you're trying to be the perfect employee at this point, and perfect employees don't cut out early for Jimmy's baseball game.

22. So, explain why I should hire you.

As I'm sure you know, "Because I'm great" or "I really need a job" are not good answers here. This is a time to give the employer a laundry list of your greatest talents that just so happens to match the job description. It's also good to avoid taking potshots at other potential candidates here. Focus on yourself and your talents, not other people's flaws.

23. Finally, do you have any questions to ask me?

I'll finish the way I started, with one of the most common questions asked in interviews. This directly relates to the research you've done on the company and also gives you a chance to show how eager and prepared you are. You'll probably want to ask about benefits if they haven't been covered already. A good generic one is "How soon could I start—if I were offered the job, of course." You may also ask what you'd be working on, specifically, in

the role you're applying for, and how that affects the rest of the company. Always have questions ready; greeting this one with a blank stare is a rotten way to finish your interview. Good luck, and happy job hunting.

— Paul Michael

6 Warning Signs That You Shouldn't Take That Job

You're scouting around for a decent job. While you realize that great jobs are hard to find, you're avoiding getting into a position that really stinks. Here are six telltale characteristics of generally lousy jobs, and why it may be best to cut and run.

1. They run vague ads

While you can't always expect potential employers to give a detailed bio in a three-inch ad space, there are subtle ways to let you know who you may be working for. Classifieds that don't even let you know what industry you'll